

CAPITAL FLOWS & NETWORK GROWTH

Network Baseline: 3,736 BTC across 33,549 Active Channels • 12,542 Discovered Nodes



+5,306 Opened

+1,981.02 BTC added

Median Size: 10M sats

-6,971 Closed

-1,968.88 BTC settled

Avg Settlement: 28,243,867 sats

+12.14 BTC Net Flow

MoM Shift: +537.34 BTC

Prior Month: -525.20 BTC (-1,665 chans)

Daily Channel Activity (Opened vs Closed)

Daily opened vs closed channels in September 2026



Daily Peak Close: Day 23 (-989) • Daily Mean: +177 / -232 chans

6-Month Net Flow (BTC)

Net BTC added or removed each month



6-Month Cumulative Flow: -1,115.6 BTC

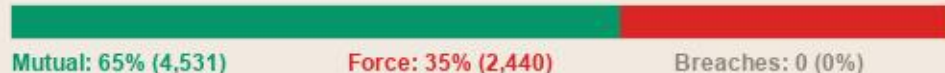
CHANNEL SETTLEMENTS & TAPROOT ADOPTION

6,971 Channels Settled in September 2026 • Median Lifespan: 41 Days • Taproot: 1.80%

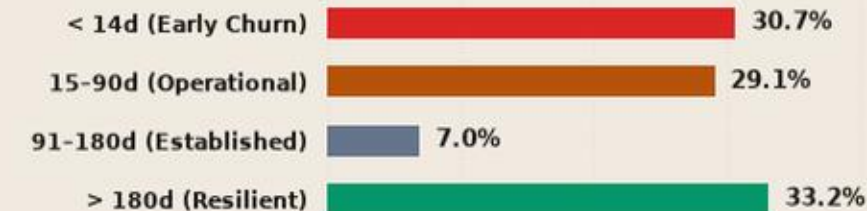


Settlement Breakdown & Lifespan

Cooperative vs unilateral settlements & on-chain duration



SETTLED CHANNEL LIFESPAN DISTRIBUTION



SHORT-LIVED CHURN (<14 DAYS)

2,140 channels closed shortly after funding via LSP rebalancing & test probes.

RESILIENT BACKBONE (>180 DAYS)

2,314 mature channels anchor routing connectivity across core network peers.

SETTLEMENT EFFICIENCY & SECURITY

Zero fraudulent breach attempts broadcasted across the network.

65% settled cooperatively at minimal fees; 35% force closes incurred CSV timelocks.

Taproot Channels (P2TR / MuSig2)

Adoption of Point-Time Locks (PTLC) & Schnorr Key Aggregation



TAPROOT SIZING PROFILE

Median: 2,500,000 sats (vs 2,000,000 sats SegWit) • Mean: 0.111 BTC

Tier Distribution: 8% Freeway (>1 BTC) • 52% Highway • 40% My Way

Higher median reflects deliberate capital deployment by power routing operators.

ADOPTER PROFILE: EXPERIMENTAL & ROUTING TESTBEDS

78% opened by hobbyists & enthusiasts testing LND v0.17+ & CLN.

22% dev testbeds. Commercial LSPs remain on SegWit v0 pending gossip specs.

TOPOLOGY TIERS & CAPITAL CONCENTRATION

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Channel Sizing Tiers & MoM Shift

Net capital flow & channel count shift across capacity tiers



INSTITUTIONAL FREEWAY CORRIDORS (> 1 BTC)

+37 pipes added 74.6 BTC net • Total: 581 (42% capacity)

Capital is concentrating into high-volume conduits for scalable routing.

RETAIL & EDGE CONSOLIDATION (< 1 BTC)

-1,702 channels closed net (-62.4 BTC shift) across retail tiers

Node operators pruned sub-economic channels to optimize routing fee efficiency.

CAPITAL REDISTRIBUTION TREND

Capital is concentrating into high-throughput Freeway corridors, while smaller retail channels consolidate on-chain to boost efficiency.

Node Sizing & Capital Pareto

Institutional routing hubs vs sovereign edge plebs



CORE ROUTING FEDERATION (POWERHOUSES & PILLARS)

1,605 nodes (15.7%) anchor 98.7% of capacity (3,687 BTC)

Commercial LSPs and dedicated operators sustain core network liquidity.

SOVEREIGN EDGE DECENTRALIZATION (PLEBS)

8,629 sovereign nodes (84.3%) • +255 new entrants

Community runners form an expansive periphery, preserving censorship resistance.

ROUTING CENTRALIZATION & MESH DYNAMICS

A compact core of 185 Powerhouse hubs provides deep liquidity, while over 8,600 sovereign pleb nodes ensure decentralized edge access.